



Surgical Orthodontics (Jaw Surgery)

Purpose: Corrective jaw surgery to realign the jaws, improve bite function, and enhance facial balance, often in conjunction with orthodontic treatment.

First 24–72 Hours:

- Significant swelling and bruising are normal.
- Apply ice packs to the face for the first 24 hours, then switch to warm compresses to reduce swelling.
- Keep head elevated while resting.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Take prescribed pain relievers and antibiotics as directed.
- Numbness in lips, cheeks, or chin may occur and can last several weeks.

Oral Hygiene:

- Follow your surgeon's instructions for cleaning the mouth; often includes gentle rinsing with antimicrobial solution.
- Avoid brushing near surgical sites until cleared.

Diet:

- Liquid or pureed diet initially, transitioning to soft foods as directed.
- Avoid chewing until your surgeon advises it is safe.

Special Precautions:

- Do not smoke or consume alcohol during recovery.
- Avoid strenuous activity until cleared by your surgeon.
- Elastic bands or wires may be in place—do not remove unless instructed.

Follow-Up:

- Multiple follow-up visits will be required to monitor healing and adjust orthodontic appliances.
- Contact your surgeon if you experience persistent bleeding, difficulty breathing, severe pain, or signs of infection.